

23 — Agency Accessibility and Capture Geometry

Professional reading edition of the evolving public MKUFT canon

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Scientific affiliation	Independent Researcher
Object status	Research module reading edition — not a standalone Zenodo publication
Public source	Open canonical public source
Source commit	26e06b6fea52e6b052dbdd540e80d1d926b96b07
MKUFT backbone DOI	10.5281/zenodo.17780566

Status boundary. This PDF is a reader-facing rendering of an evolving GitHub research module. It is not a frozen standalone paper and does not receive a separate DOI. The cited Git commit fixes the exact source identity of this edition.

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1. Core distinction

A person or system may retain a real capacity while losing practical access to it.

Structural capacity is not the same thing as practical accessibility.

This avoids two false extremes: treating agency as entirely absent whenever access is impaired, or treating abstract capacity as proof that normal access to choice remains intact.

The capacity for choice may remain while the map required to recognise, evaluate, and use available options becomes distorted.

2. Action-space model

At time t , let:

- U_t be the actions actually available;
- $\bar{U}_t$ be the actions perceived as available;
- $V_t(u)$ be the estimated value of action u ;
- $T_t(u)$ be the perceived threat, shame, betrayal, identity loss, or punishment attached to u ;
- H_t represent reinforcement history, dependency, trauma, habit, loyalty, and prior choices;
- $G_t(u; T_t, H_t)$ be a normalised gating function determining whether u enters reflective consideration.

Require

$$G_t(u; T_t, H_t) \in [0, 1], \quad \theta_{\text{access}} \in [0, 1].$$

The practically accessible set is

$$U_t^{\text{access}} = \{u \in U_t : G_t(u; T_t, H_t) > \theta_{\text{access}}\}.$$

A viable exit can remain in U_t while disappearing from U_t^{access} .

The threshold is a modelling device. A probabilistic or graded-access model may be preferable where the domain does not support a hard gate.

Capture deepens when exits are not perceived, labelled impossible, assigned catastrophic cost, marked as betrayal, fused with identity loss, or filtered out before comparison.

3. Agency accessibility

Let

$$a_t \in [0, 1]$$

represent practical access to retained agency. A simple operational distinction is

$$\text{Agency}_{\text{effective}}(t) = \text{Agency}_{\text{capacity}} a_t.$$

This is not a complete moral, legal, or clinical equation. Both terms require domain-specific operational definitions before quantitative use.

Low accessibility may be associated with fear conditioning, trauma, addiction, coercion, dependency, information control, ideological enclosure, exhaustion, shame, social punishment, or corrupted attribution. Capacity may survive while its interface is degraded.

4. Attribution capture

Attribution capture occurs when an installed or reinforced impulse, demand, rule, or attractor is misidentified as the agent's own deepest identity, conscience, or will.

A possible sequence is:

external, internal, or emergent pressure → repeated routing → identity association → attribution error → defence of the installed pattern.

Possible indicators include punishment of reflection, contradiction increasing loyalty rather than examination, an enclosure being defended as freedom, exit language being heard as betrayal, imposed cost being reinterpreted as proof of virtue, or system defences being repeated before the underlying claim is examined.

None of these indicators alone establishes capture.

5. Capture geometry

Capture is defined structurally rather than by one assumed root ontology. It describes an accessible action map narrowed around an attractor that rewards repetition, punishes accurate reflection, hides alternatives, preserves dependency, redirects responsibility, raises exit cost, or recruits the agent to defend the enclosure.

For audit purposes, let

$$B_t, D_t, F_t, S_t \in [0, 1]$$

where B_t denotes basin depth or reinforcement strength, D_t distortion between actual and perceived action sets, F_t threat-gating applied to viable exits, and S_t self-identification with the attractor.

A heuristic capture index is

$$K_{\text{capture}}(t) = B_t D_t F_t S_t.$$

This is a decomposition tool rather than a validated diagnostic score. The multiplicative form encodes a conjunction assumption: when one factor approaches zero, the product falls sharply. Additive, interaction, threshold, and probabilistic alternatives remain valid competitors where data permit.

6. Responsibility gradient

Responsibility may vary across a capture trajectory. Repeated reinforcement or avoidance may deepen a basin and narrow later accessibility.

A careful assessment separates retained capacity, current accessibility, earlier voluntary reinforcement, present coercion or impairment, available evidence of reflection, harm caused to others, realistic exit opportunities, and action taken when clarity returns.

Understanding does not automatically excuse behaviour, and accountability does not require dehumanisation.

7. S–I–P–O placement

Capture is modelled as a post-boundary structure.

S — Substrate

Source or unity is not itself the local capture mechanism. Capture requires differentiated agents, boundaries, and distorted maps.

I — Information

Relevant structures include corrupted meaning, false attribution, identity fusion, installed attractors, damaged action maps, mislabelled exits, and distorted cost or value estimates.

O — Observer

Gating may be stabilised through salience, attention, fear, shame, loyalty, expectation, selective memory, and threat interpretation.

P — Physical

Reinforcement may be enacted through body state, addiction, trauma response, sleep loss, coercion, institutions, reward, punishment, and material dependency.

Temporal and relational structure

Repetition may deepen the basin. Accurate feedback, trustworthy relationship, accountability, material safety, and restored interpretation may reopen access over time.

A candidate capture sequence is:

differentiated agent → corrupted I-layer map → O-layer threat-gating → P-layer reinforcement → deeper basin.

A corresponding recovery sequence is:

accurate recognition → corrected action map → reduced false threat → practical access → changed action → weakened basin.

These are candidate causal sequences, not movement through literal additional physical dimensions. Each measured application requires defined variables and timescales.

8. Recovery mechanics

Recovery may begin by restoring recognition of an existing route rather than inventing a new one.

Candidate interventions include naming the pattern without attacking human worth; preserving records and sequence; separating self from installed impulse; reducing material dependency; creating low-cost trial exits; restoring sleep and physical stability; rebuilding trustworthy relationships; testing feared consequences in bounded steps; making alternatives visible; assigning responsibility without humiliation; interrupting reinforcement loops; and reconnecting with prior values and memory.

These are general systems observations rather than individual treatment instructions.

9. Relationship to ambiguity dynamics

A capturing system may preserve itself through unstable definitions, unclear responsibility, exaggerated exit costs, uncertain attribution, and identity fusion.

In the language of [Ambiguity Dynamics and Manoeuvre Space](#), high unresolved state volume, low-cost frame-switching, and preserved dependency may jointly increase manoeuvrability around the attractor.

This is a structural compression, not an additional diagnostic equation. Clarification helps only when it accurately contracts false routes; humiliation, false certainty, or coercive confrontation may instead deepen threat-gating.

10. Applications

The model may be applied cautiously to coercive control, abusive relationships, addiction, cultic systems, extremist recruitment, institutional capture, propaganda, trauma loops, learned helplessness, compulsive behaviour, organisational obedience, adversarial human–AI interaction, and identity-based manipulation.

It is not a substitute for clinical, legal, safeguarding, or other domain-specific assessment.

11. Ontology boundary

Two questions remain separate:

1. Is a person or system organised by a capture geometry?
2. What caused that geometry?

Candidate causes include human coercion, trauma, addiction, incentives, cognitive bias, ideology, deliberate manipulation, emergent dynamics, metaphysical hypotheses, mixed causes, or unresolved causes.

Pattern fit does not independently prove an external intelligence. Uncertainty about ultimate cause does not erase observable coercion, dependency, or action-map distortion.

12. Predictions

Deep capture should correlate with a larger difference between actual and perceived action sets, higher threat assigned to viable exits, stronger identity fusion, increased defence when reflection is requested, narrowing social and informational access, improved practical agency after accurate map restoration, basin weakening after successful low-cost exits, and relapse when dependency and reinforcement return.

Argument alone should often fail where the primary barrier is threat-gating, material dependency, or body-state reinforcement.

13. Falsifiers and limits

The model is weakened if actual and perceived action sets cannot be distinguished; independent raters cannot apply the variables reliably; restored information does not improve practical access where material constraints are controlled; threat-gating does not predict exit avoidance; identity fusion does not correlate with attractor defence; the threshold or multiplicative model performs worse than simpler alternatives; or the framework produces no testable intervention difference.

The model also fails if it becomes merely a label for disagreement. Ordinary disagreement, loyalty, faith, duty, and sacrifice cannot be erased by calling them capture, and reduced accessibility does not imply zero moral agency.

14. Related public documents

- [Ambiguity Dynamics and Manoeuvre Space](#)
- [OCQS Human Activation Layer](#)
- [Mathematical Appendix](#)
- [Typed Traversal and Equation Hygiene](#)
- [Falsification Summary](#)
- [Cross-Support and Traversal Map](#)

15. Compressed rule

Freedom may remain structurally present while the map required to recognise and use it has been corrupted.

Restore the map, lower false threat, reopen the route, then assess the action.